

RIGHTS CONGRESS FACES NEW WOES

Donor Blunders, Sending Fund Plea to Head of Joint Inquiry Committee

The Civil Rights Congress was faced yesterday with a new investigation—because one of its contributors blundered.

State Senator Edward P. Larkin, Republican of Nassau, said he would ask State Attorney General Jacob K. Javits to find out if the left-wing organization was "flouting any law" in its new appeal for money.

Senator Larkin is chairman of a joint legislative committee that denounced the congress at public hearings here last month. The committee called it a Communist front and said it diverted to subversive uses money it had gathered from the public in the guise of worthy causes. Senator Larkin charged that the congress, which is listed as subversive by the United States Attorney General, had sought to impede the investigation into philanthropy rackets by withholding many of its financial records and deliberately making others unintelligible.

It developed yesterday that the congress had sent to its list of contributors a new appeal for gifts, along with an attack upon the legislative committee. The new mailing contains a blast against the Larkin committee as "a tool of McCarthyism."

It contains also a postcard to be forwarded to Governor Harriman with a protest that the Larkin committee had perverted its original purpose of investigating rackets to attack politically unpopular causes. And it has a form letter of denunciation to be mailed to Senator Larkin.

Senator Larkin got an envelope in the mail. But this one didn't contain the denunciatory letter with which he said he was familiar by now. It contained the congress' letter requesting new contributions to be used for "defending not only the Civil Rights Congress but all other organizations of a democratic character who may come under attack by Government agencies."

Senator Larkin said the mailer had written across the letter: "You are sending me two of every mailing. Please take my name off one of the lists and save money." It was apparent, said Mr. Larkin, that the letter he received had been intended for sending back to the congress but had gone into the wrong envelope. It did not contain a contribution.